

Lifting high

An enormous floating crane lifts a large section of the Zhoushan-Daishan bridge in China, which was under construction in 2021. These cranes require two separate systems of pulleys to handle their loads. While one system lifts the load, the other lifts the arms that are carrying the load.

The long, thick metal ropes pass over many pulley wheels inside the block and tackle.

This concrete girder will form part of the bridge.

This crane can lift girders each weighing **2,000 tons (1,800 tonnes)**—the same weight as 400 adult elephants.



FLOATING PLATFORM

Cranes with huge metal arms that are mounted on boats and used to perform tasks in water are called floating sheerlegs. They are often used in construction, for loading and unloading cargo from ships, and to fish out sunken wrecks from the bottom of the sea.

